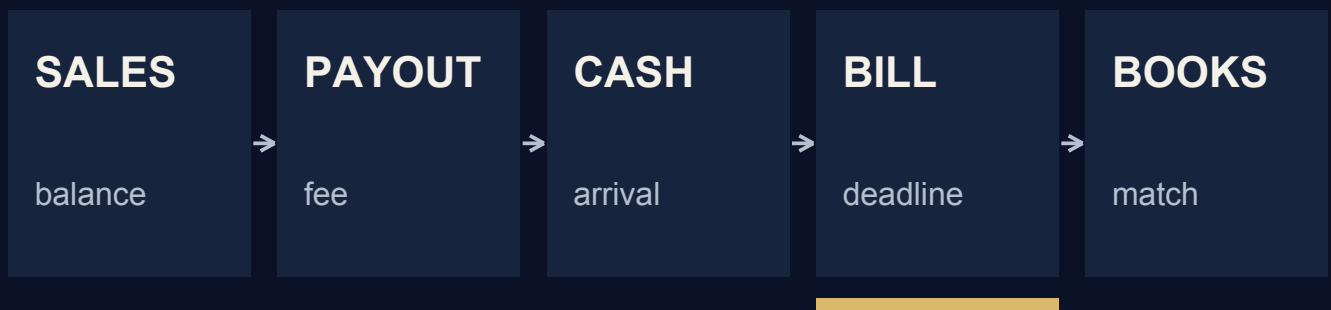


The price of Friday

Pay \$15 to save 55 cents? A deadline can change the answer.

FOLLOW THE MONEY TO ITS USE



A faster transfer matters when it changes what happens next.

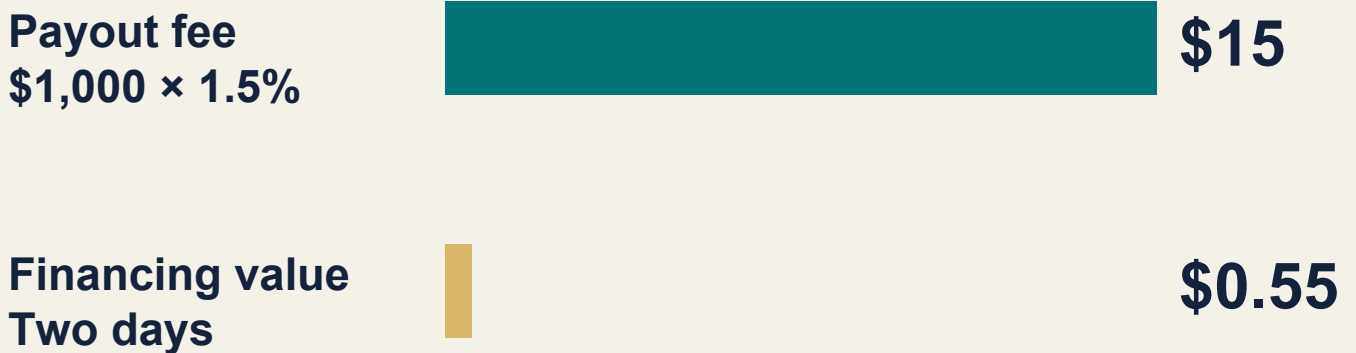
Fictional US shop. No customer case or payment experiment. All amounts are USD; eligibility and limits apply.

The same fast payout can have very different customer value.

Speed starts \$14.45 behind

Assume a \$1,000 fee base, two calendar days gained and 10% annual funding cost.

DOLLARS: FEE VERSUS SIMPLE FINANCING VALUE



Two days and 10% are assumptions, not provider promises. Other fees and operating work are excluded.

Financing savings alone do not cover the \$15 payout fee.

The deadline creates a fork

Suppose late cash triggers a \$40 supplier charge. This is an invented scenario.

SAME \$1,000 BALANCE

Compare usable cash against the same payment deadline.

ARRIVES IN TIME

Assume the faster payout prevents the charge. Pay \$15 for speed.

ARRIVES TOO LATE

Assume a \$40 charge occurs. Its likelihood still needs evidence.

The arrows show alternative outcomes, not measured merchant performance. No charge is assumed in every real case.

Value comes from the loss prevented, as well as interest saved.

A probability can reverse the choice

Assume earlier cash prevents the entire charge whenever it would occur.

LATE-CHARGE CHANCE	EXPECTED LOSS AVOIDED	NET VALUE OF SPEED
100%	\$40.00	+\$25.55
20%	\$8.00	-\$6.45
About 36.1%	About \$14.45	Break-even

Net = chance × \$40 + \$0.547945 – \$15. Other incremental costs excluded; probabilities are hypothetical.

A certain \$40 saving and a possible \$40 saving are different.

The bank balance is only part of the bill

A provider publishes its fee. The user still needs to price the work and alternatives.

KNOWN RESPONSIBILITY

Match the transactions

Stripe assigns instant payout reconciliation to the user.

The user chooses the amount and timing.

Comparable labor minutes are not supplied in this source.

UNPRICED IN THIS MODEL

Compare the whole choice

Additional matching work could raise the cost.

Cheaper available funding could change the choice.

A high fee alone does not establish a durable margin.

Documentation establishes a task, not its measured labor cost. No merchant records were accessed.

Add measured operating costs before calling speed a saving.

Give the deadline a price

For an investor, repeatable customer benefit matters more than a speed headline.

COMPLETE THIS SENTENCE

If this money arrives later...

...this specific thing happens.

Name the consequence. Estimate its probability from evidence. Compare the fee, alternatives and extra work.

A small decision model / No measured customer outcome

Ask what a late arrival would cost this customer, on this day.

Check the terms. Keep the assumptions.

Read the provider documents and the research that prompted this story.

S1 **Stripe Instant Payouts (Dashboard)**

Living documentation · checked 25 Sep 2026

S2 **Stripe payout reconciliation report**

Living documentation · checked 25 Sep 2026

S3 **Instant Cash Can Mean Slower Books**

2026-09-25 · checked 25 Sep 2026

Terms can change. US Dashboard pricing is not a global tariff. No payment, account access or measured savings are claimed.

The fee is sourced. The shop, deadline and probabilities are invented.